



The future of TV

Internet has replaced TV already, but television might still have a future with its rescue plans. <http://dgit.in/FtreTV>



Keyboard for iPad

Razer has launched a mechanical keyboard for the iPad, designed for tablets. <http://dgit.in/iMKeybd>

Budget Smartphones

Qualcomm Snapdragon 615 on-board, instead of the last year's Snapdragon 410. This may have improved the performance of the phone but compared to the competition it is still average. That said, the octa-core SoC works flawlessly when usual tasks such as watching video, messaging apps or just social media is concerned. However, when we tried playing multiple games back to back, it resulted in occasional stutters on the Zenfone Max.

As for the build and design of the phone, there is little to talk about. The Asus Zenfone Max's design is based on the year old Zenfone 2's design. Like all Zenfones that have come before this, the material of choice here is plastic. Now, it is not as sturdy as some other phones in this shootout offering a metal build but the faux leather back it offers is still one of the most non-slippery backs we have seen on a device. However, at 202 grams, this is not a light phone to carry by any measure.

The 13MP rear camera on the phone is pretty average and the images taken come out oversaturated and low on details.

LEEEO LE 1S (ECO)

The LeEco Le 1s can be best described as the subsidized version of the original LeEco Le 1s. The phone is almost exactly the same as the Le 1s and in addition it also offers LeEco's supertainment package. In this supertainment package, you get content from Eros Now, YupTV, Hungama music and more. According to the company, the year long subscription

of the same costs about Rs. 4,900. Now, this might just be the phone if you want the content but even if you don't, this is still one of the best phones to buy under the 11K budget.

The Le 1s (Eco) has an all metal build, which makes it sturdy and makes it look premium. The 5.5-inch display has minimal bezels, adding to the overall look and ergonomics of the phone. The display itself however, is somewhat on the dim side and its sunlight legibility is not very ideal. That said, the viewing angles are good and colours look quite well balanced.

While you may or may not like the LeEco's eUI, the performance is one of the pros of the device. Powered by a MediaTek Helio X10 SoC, the phone is swift and does not slow down very easily. The phone also quite when gaming is concerned but it is still lacks the performance of the similarly priced Xiaomi Redmi Note 3. The 13MP rear camera on the other hand is not that great and just lies in the average line.

XIAOMI REDMI 3S PRIME

Xiaomi's latest edition to the budget segment is slightly cheaper and slightly less powerful version of the Redmi Note 3. The smaller 5-inch device offers a similar design and build as the Redmi Note 3. The material of choice is metal and the Xiaomi hasn't cut down on quality. The phone is also incredibly light considering the device packs a 4100mAh battery, which is 50mAh bigger than the one used by the Redmi Note 3. That said, the phone is able



Xiaomi Redmi 3S Prime

to provide a similar battery life as the Redmi Note 3.

Powering the device is a Qualcomm Snapdragon 430 SoC. This is the first phone in India to be powered by this octa-core SoC. In our tests, the phone performed slightly better than the Snapdragon 616, making this a very a good phone for its price. Gaming does not slow the phone down but during heavy gaming, occasional frame drops were visible. Also, the temperatures never went over 40 degree celsius during our tests, which is quite good. The 13MP rear camera shows promise in well lit and outdoor light conditions but it is unable to cope with low light that well. Overall the camera is quite acceptable at its price.

COOLPAD NOTE 3 PLUS

The Note 3 from Coolpad went on to become one of the best phones in the budget

segment last year, but it had one shortcoming, a 720p display. With the Note 3 Plus, Coolpad has solved just that, as the display resolution on the Coolpad Note 3 Plus is 1080p. Besides that, it is pretty much the same phone. It is made out of the same soft touch plastic and features a super fast fingerprint scanner at the back.

It is also powered by the same MediaTek MT6753 SoC, which is again coupled with 3GB of RAM. Add the new display to the mix, and we end up with a phone inferior to the Coolpad Note 3. The performance has dropped and there are far more lags while gaming. Although, we did not encounter any major hiccups using the phone as a daily driver with minimum gaming. The 13MP rear camera on the other hand seems a little sharper compared to the original Coolpad Note 3. However, it is still lacks behind other contenders which are part of this shootout.

LENOVO VIBE K5 PLUS

The Lenovo Vibe K5 Plus is a small, good looking phone and one of the cheapest buys in our shootout. It features a plastic build but to add a bit of premium touch to the design, the removable back of the phone is covered in a thin metal sheet. While the phone is well built, the metal back is a bit slippery to hold. Adding to the small form factor is the 5-inch display, which offers a 1080p resolution. Now the viewing angles and colour saturation are decent but it is still not what you call a quality display.

Powering the device is the Qualcomm Snapdragon